

Rising intensity, and what drives it

The PN's reading of Eurostat's greenhouse gas intensity figures, tested

THE CLAIM

“Malta is the only EU Member State which ... increased the intensity of greenhouse gas emissions from 2013 ...”

Partit Nazzjonalista press release, signed by Eve Borg Bonello, 26 January 2026

It cites Eurostat (Malta +17%, EU –34%) and blames a lack of ambition on several fronts, among them, renewables.

Our translation of the Maltese release. Eurostat's 2024 values are estimates.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

Eurostat's figure is right; since 2013 the rise is airline fuel (2024 estimate).

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+14%

Only rise in the EU

Eurostat's indicator, 2013–2024 (+17% in January); EU –34%. 2024 is an estimate.

72%

Airline fuel bought abroad

Share of Malta's 2024 figure (2024 estimate, Eurostat flag i); firms resident in Malta are counted wherever they fly.

–64%

Without air transport

Same indicator since 2013 (EU's 2nd-largest fall); a fall from every base year 2008–2023, –29.5% since 2016.

–61%

Territorial inventory

Emissions in Malta per euro of GDP since 2013; a fall from every base year 2008–2023, –27% since 2016.

+1.4%

With zero power-sector emissions

In 2024 the indicator would still be above 2013: more renewable electricity, on its own, could not have removed the rise.

FAIR TO SAY

The PN quoted Eurostat's own headline correctly, and from base years 2014–2019 Malta's rise is larger (+19.5% to +97%). Malta's renewable shares are low (10.7% of electricity, the EU's lowest). The issue is what the figure counts.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The PN's source for “third from last”.

☐ Which other “fronts” the PN had in mind.

☐ Which airline operations drive the series.

☐ Malta's reported 2024 accounts.